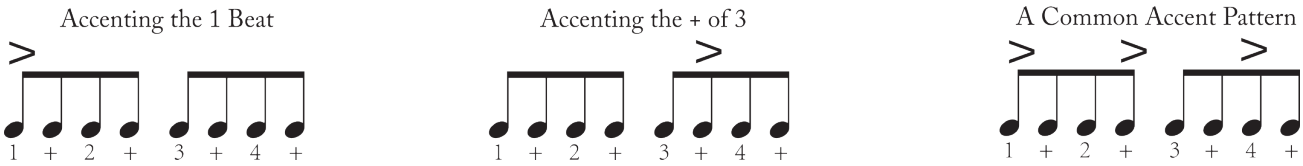
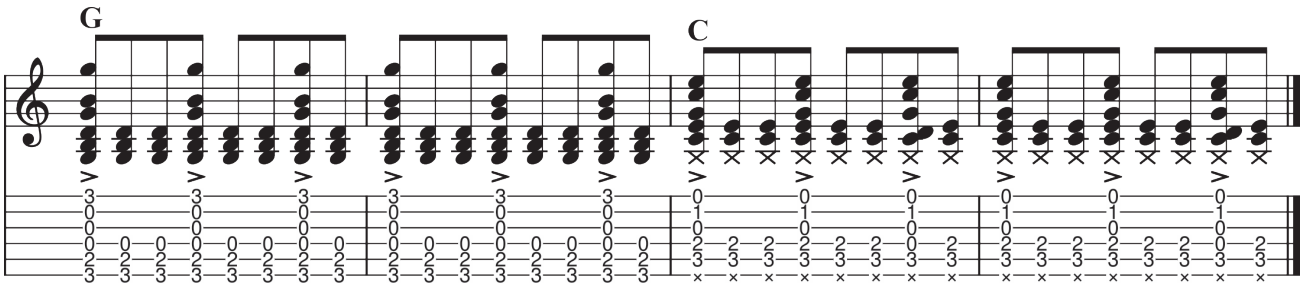
LESSON 3: ACCENTS

An accented strum is played (and counted!) louder than the surrounding strums. It is notated with a > symbol above the note. To perform an accent, strum all of chord's notes loudly. Non-accented strums can be created by softly strumming only a few notes of the chord (usually the low/bass notes).

Below are three simple accenting patterns. Practice each of these measures on a loop, using any chord, until they're comfortable. Focus on dynamics, the loudness and softness of each strum. Remember to only use downstrums for now.



Here's that third pattern applied to a simple G to C progression and written for standard guitar tablature. Notice how non-accented strums only display a few notes of the chord; these are just guidelines, there is no precise amount of strings you're required to hit.



Also notice how during the C major chord, the lowest string displays that the "X" fret should be played. This means that the string should be muted with either:

- Your fretting-hand's thumb (which can be wrapped around the top of the neck to slightly graze the 6th string and prevent it from ringing).
- Your ring finger (which can be placed in a way where it bumps up against the string).